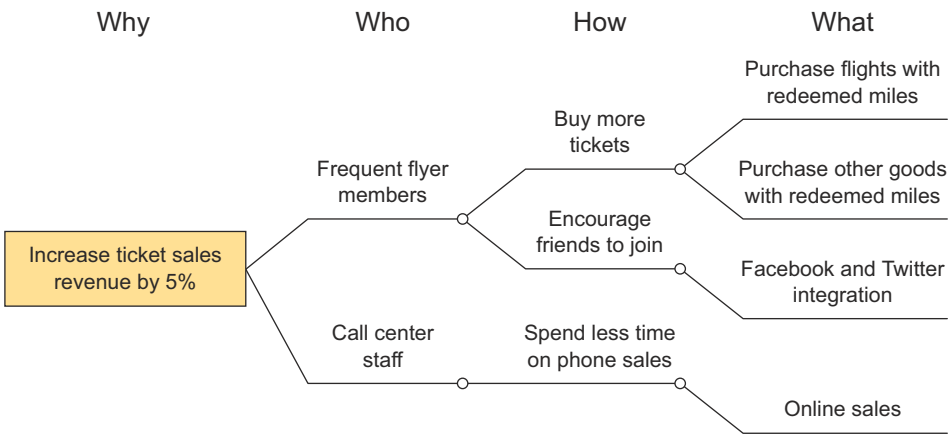


Figure 3.8 What can you do to encourage or allow the stakeholders to modify their behavior to help achieve the business goal?

The last type of question you need to ask is *what*. What can your application do to support the impacts you've listed in the previous three stages? Or are there other ways to achieve these results without using software? In the context of building an application, the "what" corresponds to high-level features. You may need to break these high-level features down into more detailed ones as your understanding of the requirements increases, until you get to a manageable size. In an Agile project, these features are good candidates for high-level user stories or epics. If you're using a Unified Process methodology, they might become use cases.

In our example, you might encourage Frequent Flyer members to buy more tickets by making it easier to redeem miles on flights or on other products (see figure 3.8). You might make it easier to talk about the great deal they just got with their Frequent Flyer discounts on Facebook or Twitter. And you might reduce the number of telephone bookings by determining what sort of bookings are being done over the phone and making online purchases for these tickets easier.

Impact Mapping helps you visualize how features and deliverables contribute to a business goal. It also helps underline any assumptions you may be making. For example, here you're assuming that Facebook and Twitter integration will be enough for Frequent Flyer members to proudly post about all their trips. Impact Mapping encourages you not only to sketch out these relationships and assumptions, but also to define metrics that you can use when the feature goes live to test whether your assumption was correct. In this case, you might keep track of the number of Facebook and Twitter posts that are generated by Frequent Flyer members in order to learn how effective your new social media integration strategy really is.

It's important to remember that impact maps are not plans: they're iterative, living documents that can help you visualize assumptions and relationships between capabilities and business goals. Whenever you deliver something into production,